A FREE COMPANION GUIDE

10 Financial Conversations to Have Before You Get Married

Because love is not a financial plan.

Questions to help you and your partner talk about money, expectations, ownership, and your future — before saying “I do.”

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A NOTE BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Have the conversation before the commitment

You do not have to agree on every financial decision. You do need to understand each other's expectations — and how you will make decisions together.

In my first marriage, I learned that caring about someone and planning a financial future together are not the same thing. We left important questions unspoken. Some of those silences became expensive lessons.

This guide is not about expecting your marriage to fail. It is about starting with clarity, honesty, and respect for both people. Work through the questions together, one conversation at a time.

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Set aside time without distractions. Each person answers before discussing. Listen for differences without treating them as a failure. Write down what you agree on — and what still needs attention.

A reminder: Financial and property laws vary by location and circumstance. This guide is educational, not individualized legal, tax, or financial advice. Consult qualified professionals when needed.

CONVERSATIONS 1–3

Start with what you believe

01 What did we learn about money growing up?

Family experiences shape expectations about who earns, spends, saves, and makes decisions.

- What did “financial security” look like in your childhood home?
- Which expectations do you want to keep — or change?

02 What does a fair contribution look like?

Equal dollar amounts may not feel fair when income, time, and responsibilities differ.

- How will we divide housing, groceries, bills, and unexpected costs?
- When will we revisit the arrangement if circumstances change?

03 What do we each owe and own?

Transparency about debt and assets gives both people a realistic starting point.

- What debts, savings, credit obligations, and major assets do we each have?
- Are there financial commitments to family or others we should discuss?

CONVERSATIONS 4–6

Make the invisible visible

04 How will we manage accounts and bills?

Separate, joint, or mixed accounts can work when the system is understood and regularly reviewed.

- Who tracks bills, and who can access the information?
- What will we do if one person feels overwhelmed?

05 What does ownership really mean for us?

Paying toward an asset, signing a loan, and holding legal title are different matters.

- Whose names will appear on deeds, titles, loans, and accounts?
- Will we seek independent advice before signing major documents?

06 Have we discussed a prenuptial agreement?

A thoughtful conversation can reveal assumptions about debts, property, and long-term protection.

- What would we want to understand or protect before marriage?
- Would independent legal advice help each of us make an informed decision?

CONVERSATIONS 7–8

Protect both futures

07 What happens to our individual ambitions?

Partnership should make room for careers, education, relocations, and personal goals.

- How would we handle a career opportunity that requires a major change?
- How will we recognize and discuss sacrifices rather than assume them?

08 What will we do when money feels stressful?

Financial stress is emotional as well as practical. A shared process can prevent one person from carrying it alone.

- How do we each react when account balances are lower than expected?
- What information, reassurance, or action helps us move forward together?

A useful habit: Schedule a monthly money meeting. Review upcoming expenses, changes in income, progress toward goals, and any decisions that need both voices.

CONVERSATIONS 9–10

Plan beyond the wedding

09 What are we building over the next five years?

Shared direction matters more than simply getting through the next month.

- What are our priorities for savings, housing, retirement, or a business?
- How much do we want to save, and what tradeoffs are we willing to make?

10 What is our plan when life changes?

Plans should account for illness, lost income, caregiving, separation, or unexpected emergencies.

- What reserves, insurance, documents, or professional advice should we explore?
- How would we reassess responsibilities after a major life event?

THE QUESTION UNDER ALL TEN

Do we both feel informed, heard, and protected in the financial life we are building together?

YOUR NEXT STEP

Turn the conversation into a plan

Start small. You do not need every answer today — just a shared commitment to ask.

One conversation we will have this week:

One financial document or account we need to understand:

One decision we need professional guidance on:

Date of our next money check-in:

If this guide made you rethink even one assumption, it has done its job. My book explores the choices I made, the lessons I learned, and why I believe financial clarity belongs in every conversation about love.

Explore the book: jennisvicente.com